

90-Day Credit Score Fix

The exact steps to raise your score fast — starting today

Free guide from kikoff.ericcoste.com

Your credit score controls your financial life — interest rates, apartment approvals, even some job offers. This cheatsheet gives you the exact 90-day playbook used by people who raised their scores by 40 to 100+ points. No fluff. No expensive services. Just the steps that actually work.

YOUR 90-DAY ROADMAP

30

DAYS

Pull reports Dispute errors Set
up autopay

60

DAYS

Lower utilization Add Kikoff
tradeline Monitor bureaus

DAYS

Score improvements Apply for
new credit Track your progress

STEP 1 — DAYS 1 TO 7

Get Your Free Credit Reports

You cannot fix what you cannot see. Pull your reports from all three bureaus at **AnnualCreditReport.com** — the only federally authorized free source. Weekly free reports are now permanently available. Download all three.

- ☐ Go to AnnualCreditReport.com (type it directly — do not search)
- ☐ Request reports from Equifax, Experian, AND TransUnion
- ☐ Download or screenshot each report
- ☐ Look for: accounts you do not recognize, wrong balances, incorrect late payments
- ☐ Note every error — you will dispute these in Step 2

STEP 2 — DAYS 7 TO 21

Dispute Every Error You Find

Under the Fair Credit Reporting Act, each bureau must investigate your dispute within 30 days. Errors are extremely common — one FTC study found 1 in 5 Americans has a material error on at least one report.

Bureau	How to Dispute	Timeframe
Equifax	equifax.com/disputes or certified mail	30 days
Experian	experian.com/disputes or certified mail	30 days
TransUnion	transunion.com/disputes or certified mail	30 days

PRO TIP For legitimate late payments, write a "goodwill letter" directly to the creditor (not the bureau). Politely explain the circumstances and ask them to remove it. This works more often than you think — especially with creditors you have paid consistently.

STEP 3 — DAYS 1 TO 30

Fix Your Credit Utilization

Credit utilization — how much of your available credit you are using — makes up **30% of your FICO score**. This is the fastest lever you can pull. The goal is to get below 30% on every card. Under 10% is optimal.

Utilization %	Impact on Score	Action Needed
Under 10%	★★★★★ Excellent	Maintain this
10% – 30%	★★★★■ Good	Acceptable, aim lower
30% – 50%	★★★██ Fair	Pay down balances now
50% – 75%	★★███ Poor	Urgent: pay down ASAP
Over 75%	★████ Damaging	Priority one

Three ways to lower utilization fast: (1) Pay down existing balances. (2) Request a credit limit increase on existing cards — same balance, higher limit = lower %. (3) Ask to be added as an authorized user on a family member's low-utilization card.

STEP 4 — START IMMEDIATELY

Add a Credit Builder Account

Payment history is 35% of your FICO score — the single biggest factor. If you have thin credit or past negatives, you need to add positive payment history to all three bureaus as quickly as possible. The most affordable way to do this in 2026 is Kikoff.

Why Kikoff? \$5/month Basic plan No credit check required No deposit, no interest Reports to all 3 bureaus Cancel anytime	Average Results 40 – 100 point increase within 12 months Positive history starts reporting in ~30 days	Get Started kikoff.ericcoste.com Use the link above for full details and plan comparison.
---	---	---

STEP 5 — ONGOING

The 5 Rules That Protect Your Score

- Never miss a payment**
Set autopay for the minimum on every account. One 30-day late can drop your score 60-110 points and stays for 7 years.
- Keep old accounts open**
The length of your credit history makes up 15% of your score. Closing old cards hurts — even ones you do not use.
- Avoid hard inquiries**
Each credit application adds a hard inquiry. Space out applications by at least 6 months. Too many in a short period signals financial stress.
- Diversify your credit mix**
FICO rewards having both revolving credit (cards) and installment loans (auto, student). A credit builder account like Kikoff adds a tradeline type that helps.
- Monitor monthly**
Use AnnualCreditReport.com (stagger: one bureau every 4 months) or a free monitoring service. Catch errors and fraud early.

QUICK-WIN CHECKLIST

Complete these actions in your first 7 days for maximum early impact.

- ☐ Pull all 3 free credit reports from AnnualCreditReport.com
- ☐ Write down every error, unfamiliar account, or incorrect balance
- ☐ File online disputes with each bureau for all errors found
- ☐ Set up autopay (minimum payment) on every open account
- ☐ Check your credit utilization — pay down any card above 50%
- ☐ Sign up for Kikoff Basic (\$5/mo) at kikoff.ericcoste.com
- ☐ Write a goodwill letter for any legitimate isolated late payment
- ☐ Add calendar reminder to check reports again in 35 days

Ready to Start Building Credit?

Kikoff is the fastest, most affordable way to add positive payment history to all 3 bureaus. Plans start at just \$5/month — no credit check, no interest, no deposit. Visit kikoff.ericcoste.com to get started today.

Affiliate Disclosure: This guide contains affiliate links. If you sign up for Kikoff through a link, a commission may be earned at no cost to you. Results vary. This is not financial advice. © 2026 Eric Coste — kikoff.ericcoste.com